LE PACTE DES LOUPS

CONCLAVE

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Introduction

Game Concept

Le Pacte des Loups: Conclave takes place during 1766, placing Silvia, an agent of the Holy See, in a fragmented Italy where the Enlightenment, along with the mystical Freemasons, are attempting to overthrow the Vatican. The game is a 3D action adventure with a focus on stealth, featuring an emergent narrative and multiple endings. Structurally, the experience is divided into eight chapters set in a wide variety of environments, where progression is based on the duality of two fundamental pillars: Action, centered on choreographed combat, and Intelligence, based on social espionage and the gathering of strategic information.

Target

- **Age**: 18+
- **Platforms**: PC, PlayStation 5, X-Box Series X/S & Nintendo Switch Systems.
- **Target audience**: Stealth game players, lovers of European history, period films, and players who appreciate a gritty narrative.

USPs

Social Infiltration: You don't just lurk in the shadows; you hide in plain sight. Use the disguise system and "social etiquette" to gain access to aristocratic parties, manipulate NPCs, and assassinate targets without drawing a weapon.

Choreographed Combat: A combat system based on rhythm and precision. You dodge attacks while using weapons to execute perfect blocks and lethal counterattacks that feel like a deadly dance.

Field Intelligence: Progress depends not only on skill with the controller, but also on the player's ability to gather information, read intercepted letters, and eavesdrop on conversations to unlock "accidental" assassination methods.

The "Villain´s" Perspective: Play as an agent of an oppressive system in a game that challenges the player's morality, urging them to maintain an increasingly flawed order. This occurs while they must confront the advance of the Enlightenment or choose to end a senseless struggle between progress and custom.

References

Dishonored

The systemic level design is adopted. The player does not have a single path, but a range of possibilities to reach their goal, fostering player agency.

Hollow Knight: Silksong

Silvia is a graceful and lethal warrior, much like the arachnid character Hornet. She's capable of resolving most fights with cunning and in short bursts.

The overall concept is that of a practically unconnected sequel to the original, starring a beloved but mysterious character.

Astral Chain

Its structure is based on a linear story told in chapters, in which each chapter takes place in an open area (like a miniature open world), in which different missions are carried out to advance the story.

Assassin's Creed: Unity

This game borrows its dynamic interactions with NPCs that react in real time to the player's actions. It also features a vertical movement system and a setting inspired by 16th-century Italy.

Hitman: World of Assassination

The "Intelligence" options combined with stealth-related skills are key to our game, and this gameplay style is heavily emphasized in the Hitman series. For this reason, Hitman: WoA has been a major source of mechanical inspiration.

Mechanics

Main Attack: A quick slash made with the blades hidden in the fan's leaves: Spine di rosa.

Parry: Block performed when Spine di Rosa's leaves are in a defensive pose, which, if done at the right moment, completely cancels the damage of an attack and executes a counterattack that knocks the enemy down.

Use secondary weapon: Activates the effect of the secondary weapon the player has equipped at that moment; the effect varies depending on which secondary weapon is equipped and can be anything from a projectile, a melee weapon, or a tool.

Dodge: Silvia performs a roll in the direction the left stick is pointing (whichever way she's facing) to get out of the way of imminent danger. If it’s perfectly timed, she enters bullet time, allowing her to launch a counterattack.

Assassin’s Focus: A state where the camera switches from third to first person (like a sniper in a shooter), allowing the player to see enemy weak points and attack for a clean, stealthy kill. Entering this state slows your walking speed by 25%, and performing any other action or taking damage will exit it.

Parkour: Pressing this button will cause Silvia to start running at full speed in the direction she's facing, jumping over small obstacles or grabbing and climbing onto ledges at her height. Jumps in this state are longer.

Hide: Silvia hides behind obstacles in the environment or by crouching, moving stealthily.

Disguise: The outfit Silvia is wearing changes her stats and allows her to infiltrate certain places or go unnoticed.

Social Etiquette: Stealth in plain sight is governed by the "Etiquette Meter" on the UI. Every disguise has a set of behavioral rules. Running in a ballroom, bumping into aristocrats, or entering restricted VIP areas while dressed as a common servant will raise the Etiquette Meter. If the meter fills, the "Social Veil" drops, blowing Silvia's cover and turning nearby guards hostile. The player must physically act the role they are playing to remain hidden.

Dialogue

Action: "Hit and run" style, focused on stealth and eliminating enemies quickly and discreetly, using gaps and openings between attack patterns.

Intelligence: Some objectives require gathering information from the environment and NPC's to progress, acting as the spy aspect of Silvia's character. When interrogating targets, the player can always choose between three dialogue options: Seduce, Threaten, or Diplomacy.

Dynamic Dialog System: Conversations are not just narrative addons; they are mechanical puzzles. The three dialogue stances (Seduce, Threaten, Diplomacy) act as "attacks" against an NPC's psychological defenses.
To guarantee success, players must use Field Intelligence. By hearing conversations or stealing letters beforehand, players unlock "Hidden Dialogue Prompts".
For example, Silvia can only successfully Threaten a Venetian noble if she previously found his account book proving his financial treason.

Elision

In the transition from the original film to the interactive environment of *Le Pacte des Loups: Conclave*, several elements have been removed to ensure the cohesion of the new narrative framework and the effectiveness of the proposed mechanics:

Environment: The rural and wooded setting of 18th-century France is omitted.

- Justification: The shift to dense urban environments (Venice, Rome, Naples) is essential to support the parkour and social stealth mechanics. This change

of scenery allows the game's visual identity to be differentiated from the film and explores a sense of verticality that the rural setting didn't facilitate.

Original Protagonists (Fronsac & Mani): The presence of the heroes from the original film is omitted.

- Justification: The goal is to avoid "reliance on a pre-established hero." Focusing the narrative on Silvia allows for ambiguous morality and espionage gameplay, conflicting with Fronsac's code of honor, whose hero's arc concluded in Africa. Mani's mysticism also doesn't fit, especially since he died in the original work.

The Beast of Gevaudan: The figure of the monster that acted as the main antagonist is eliminated.

- Justification: In this new context, the concept of "the beast" is transformed into a metaphor for institutional corruption and religious fanaticism. It is believed that including a similar creature would detract from the realism we seek to evoke through the political conflict and the tension of the social narratives.

The Pact: The structure of the French lodge seen in the movie is removed.

- Justification: It is replaced by a larger-scale (international) conspiracy network, suitable for a mission structure divided into several chapters and regions. While part of the essence of this group is reflected in its affiliation with the Freemasons.

Interpolation

With the goal of expanding the narrative universe and adding depth to the gameplay experience, new elements have been introduced that were not present in the original work:

The Thorn Conclave: A secret division is created within the Vatican, in charge of training female agents specializing in infiltration and political assassination.

- Justification: This element gives Silvia her own mythology and justifies the use of unconventional weapons (such as the war fan) and social manipulation skills. It also provides a hierarchical structure that drives the player's progression.

Social Infiltration and Disguise Management System: A gameplay mechanic is introduced that allows the protagonist to change her appearance depending on the time and place.

- Justification: Unlike the film, where Silvia's identity is concealed from the viewer, the video game encourages the player to use this "social mimicry" as another tool in their adventure. This reinforces the espionage narrative and fosters player agency, as they can decide how to complete missions, making it fun for all types of players.

Historical and Political Context of the Italian Enlightenment: Real events such as the expulsion of the Jesuits and the figures of historical personalities (Casanova, Pope Clement XIII, Maria Carolina, etc.) are integrated.

- Justification: The interpolation of real historical events serves as an anchor of verisimilitude for the player. The tension between Enlightenment ideals and religious tradition functions as the axis of the narrative conflict, elevating the story beyond a simple tale of revenge.

The Freemasons: The group is introduced as an antagonistic faction seeking to replace the Church from within with a shadow government that uses its pagan knowledge to control the population.

- Justification: This element acts as the thematic link to the original film (the use of the occult), but adapted to the spirit of the Enlightenment era, providing enemies with complex philosophical motivations.

Characters

Silvia (Protagonist)

Archetype: Morally Gray Hero

Who is she?

On the surface, she is a mysterious and melancholic high-class courtesan. However, behind that facade hides a spy for the Holy See. She is a cultured, refined, and lethal woman, possessing a profound understanding of both human weaknesses and international conspiracies.

Rol/Occupation	Assassin of the Thorn Conclave.
Alter ego	High-status courtesan.
Loyalty	The Conclave and the Pope
Training	Trained by Imperia Valenti to be an assassin for the Conclave.
Preferred weapon	Fan with a hidden blade, nicknamed by herself as Spine di Rosa.
Unique skills	Her training at the Conclave gave her knowledge of anatomy, toxicology, and manipulation techniques. She uses these to manipulate and eliminate targets stealthily.

Original Rol

In the original film, Silvia connects the events in Gevaudan to the Vatican's interests, providing key information to Grégoire de Fronsac. She intervenes directly to save him and helps eradicate the Pact of the Wolf.

Backstory

The daughter of a Venetian merchant, she was orphaned after a shipwreck that claimed her father's life. At just eight years old, she ended up in an orphanage in Rome where Imperia Valenti adopted her, intending to turn her into a weapon for the Vatican, exploiting Silvia's vulnerability as a tool for indoctrination. She made her believe that God had saved her for a glorious purpose. She was given the name Silvia, destined to maintain the natural order of the world.

What makes her vulnerable?

Her emotional isolation: she doesn't fully trust anyone and sees all her relationships as tools.

What is she looking for?

She seeks to fulfill the mission assigned to her by the Church, doing the dirty work necessary to maintain order and balance according to her superiors.

What she needs is to regain her autonomy and agency, freeing herself from years of manipulation and from being treated merely as a weapon.

What does she need?

To complete her development, Silvia must regain her autonomy and agency after having been used as a weapon for years.

Why was she chosen to star in a sequel?

- **She is Fronsac's reflection:** Both confront power from opposite sides; Silvia maintains the system while Fronsac questions it.

- **Unexplored past**: Her origins as a Vatican assassin are a mystery and contradict Church doctrine.
- **Perspective**: Silvia is not a heroine, she is a murderer, a liar, a traitor, and loyal only to the Holy See. She is not fighting for change in the world but rather seeking to perpetuate the abusive systems of the Church.
- **Gameplay**: Because of her unique abilities, Silvia was considered a character who would lead to interesting gameplay and an emergent story.

Pope Clemente XIII

Archetype: The Shadow Villain

Rol/Occupation	Leader of the Holy See.
Personality	Solemn and tormented.
Backstory	He met Silvia from an early age, serving as her spiritual guide in the world of the Conclave.
Conflict	Despite his dogma, he is tempted by the Enlightenment as the only way for the church to survive.

Giacomo Casanova

Archetype: Loyal Ally.

Rol/Occupation	Venetian spy and explorer. He is Silvia's informant in Italy.
Personality	Sybarite, eloquent, and elusive.
Backstory	Giacomo and Silvia have known each other for years through their profession. He respects her for being immune to his charm and for being his equal in wit.

Conflict	Divided between his survival instinct and his feelings towards Silvia.

Volpe

Archetype: Antagonist

Rol/Occupation	Former assassin of the Thorn Conclave; currently at the service of Alessandro.
Personality	Cold, efficient and ambitious.
Backstory	Slave sold at Rome; indoctrinated by Imperia Valenti at the Thorn Conclave.
Nickname (Meaning)	“Volpe” (Fox) alludes to her Asian heritage.
Key Relationships	Close to Silvia within the Conclave; manipulated and emotionally abused by Imperia.
Lacks	Inferiority complex and envy towards Silvia; weak to emotional manipulation and conditioned affection.
Motivations	She craves to be valued and appreciated; she seeks the power and recognition she feels has always been denied to her.

Imperia Valenti

Archetype: The Shapeshifter

Rol/Occupation	Matron of the Thorn Conclave.
Personality	Manipulative, distant and controlling.
Backstory	The illegitimate daughter of a nobleman, rejected by her family from birth. That abandonment led her to join the founding generation of the Thorn Conclave, where she transformed her resentment into control and power.
Conflict	She despises the nobility for the power she was denied. She takes pleasure in pulling strings from the shadows, like a puppeteer.

María Carolina de Austria

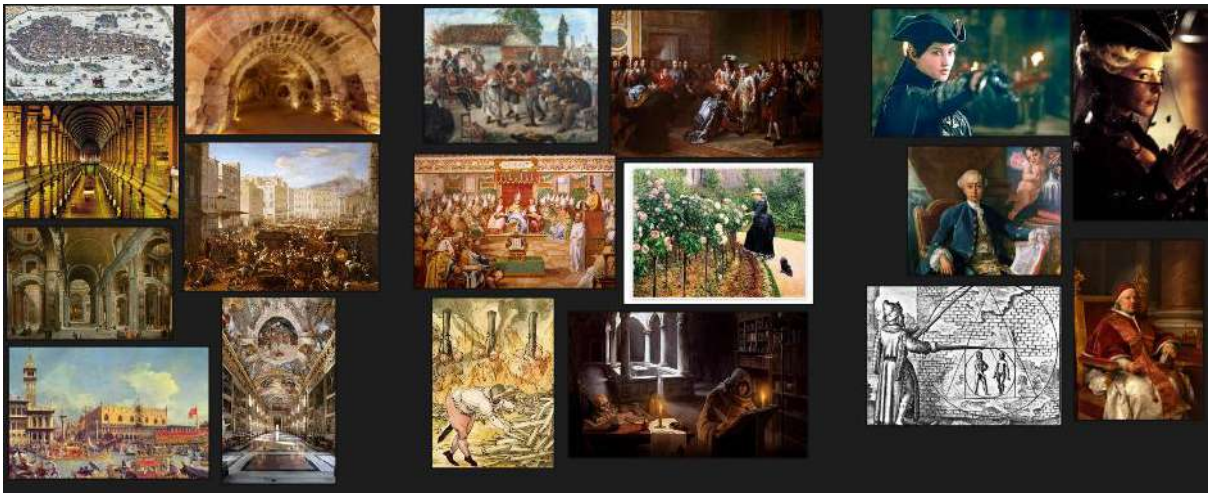
Archetype: Conditional Ally.

Rol/Occupation	Queen consort of Naples and Sicily.
Personality	Shrewd, ambitious and elegant.
Backstory	Born at the court of Vienna, she was groomed from a young age to rule. Married to Ferdinand IV of Naples, she assumes power in response to his political ineptitude, becoming the true political mind behind the kingdom.

Alessandro Cagliostro *Archetype*: The Trickster.

Rol/Occupation	Architect of the Masonic Conspiracy and Leader of the Enlightened.
Personality	Cynical and visionary.
Backstory	A count who traveled the East stealing alchemical and Masonic secrets. It was there that he encountered a dying Volpe, whom he took in with the intent of turning her into a weapon.
Conflict	He believes in reason and science as supreme truths and weaponizes them to manufacture superstition and control the masses. He holds that fear is the only reliable means of maintaining order.

Game's World



Le Pacte des Loups: Conclave is set in Italy in 1766, three years after the events that inspired the game. Unlike the rural setting of Gevaudan, the action moves to dense, vertical cities, and the level design exploits that verticality to reinforce religious and political symbolism. Italy remains fragmented into several feudal kingdoms, undergoing a profound social transition driven by the Enlightenment and the rise of anthropocentrism, ideas that steadily erode the Church's authority in favor of civil

power. Pope Clement XIII governs under mounting political and social pressure, while the expulsion of the Jesuits from European courts further accelerates the decline of ecclesiastical influence.

Factions

The Holy See: The central government of the Catholic faith and its highest authority. Led by the Pope, the ultimate interpreter of God's word, it determines the legitimacy of churches and doctrines worldwide. Its seat is Vatican City. It holds both spiritual and administrative power on a global scale, with its own legal standing and independent diplomatic relations.

The Thorn Conclave: A secret order of assassins in the service of the Pope. Born as a hidden branch of the traditional conclave, it recruits girls of promise from a young age and indoctrinates them as spies, exploiting their innocent appearance to infiltrate and destroy from within. It operates through ranks, generations and familial bonds, and is led by a Matron.

The Enlightened: A movement of intellectuals and rationalist thinkers who champion reason, knowledge and progress. They seek to eradicate superstition and religious dogma, wield growing influence over the new European nobility, and challenge the Church's political authority; advocating for a world free from absolute spiritual dominion.

The Freemasons: A brotherhood born from ancient artisan guilds that evolved into a philosophical and ritualistic order. Organized into lodges bound by symbols and secrets, they pursue moral and intellectual perfection. Having recruited radical Enlightenment thinkers into their ranks, they now seek to displace the Church entirely and establish a new world order.

General Story Outline

Act I

Chapter I: The Serpent and the Sparrow (Venice, Masquerade Festival).

Silvia is dispatched to Venice to manipulate Daniel Reiner, who is contesting his brother Paul for the position of Doge. Her ally Giacomo Casanova helps her infiltrate the festivities. During the festival, a mysterious assassin kills Daniel before Silvia can complete her mission. The chaos that follows erupts into a chase sequence and marks the beginning of the central conflict.

Chapter II: The Fox Who Crossed the Canal (Port of Ancona).

Silvia tracks the assassin to a port, where she discovers advanced machinery under construction. The assassin turns out to be Volpe, a childhood friend Silvia had believed dead, now operating at the service of the Freemasons.

Act II

Chapter III: A Thornbush (Rome, Suburbs).

Silvia reports Volpe's betrayal to the Conclave. Imperia Valenti decrees that Volpe must die for desertion. The meeting is interrupted by the attack of a supposed beast, which turns out to be a rogue machine; confirming the technological threat posed by the Enlightened.

Chapter IV: Castle at the Hill (Naples, Royal Palace).

Silvia infiltrates a gathering at María Carolina's palace, seeking records containing the secrets of the Italian nobility. María sees through her cover and proves remarkably cunning. Aware of her disadvantage, she proposes a future arrangement. The player may choose to accept the deal or assassinate her, a decision that shapes the course of the story.

Chapter V: The Wolf's Scars (Vatican Libraries).

Armed with newly gathered intelligence, Silvia follows the trail to Count Alessandro Cagliostro. Defying Imperia's orders; she infiltrates the Vatican Libraries and uncovers a connection between Cagliostro and the Holy See; his Enlightenment influence having grown hand in hand with his rise to power.

Chapter VI: The Flower That Wept (Sicily, Sulfur Mines).

Using Giacomo's intelligence network, Silvia tracks Alessandro to a set of laboratories concealed within Sicily's mines. It is revealed that Volpe serves Cagliostro directly, whose plan is to replace faith with the terror of science. Volpe is captured, but Cagliostro escapes. Upon returning to the Vatican, Imperia executes Volpe.

**During this chapter, if the player accepts María's deal, a side mission will be unlocked, leading Silvia to an elderly deserter from the Conclave; a woman who recounts her story and how she ended up alone after a lifetime of treating everyone around her as a tool. This encounter makes Silvia realize the extreme manipulation and domination that Volpe is suffering at that point of the story.*

Act III

Chapter VII: The Liar and the Protector (Florence, Cathedral).

Giacomo summons Silvia in the aftermath of Volpe's execution. After a battle of wits that mirrors the one in Chapter I, he reveals the existence of a mole within the Holy See. Silvia seeks spiritual solace by going to the Pope, and there discovers that he is the true traitor, secretly financing Freemasonry in order to build a new order. The ending depends on whether the player chooses to join him or outface him.

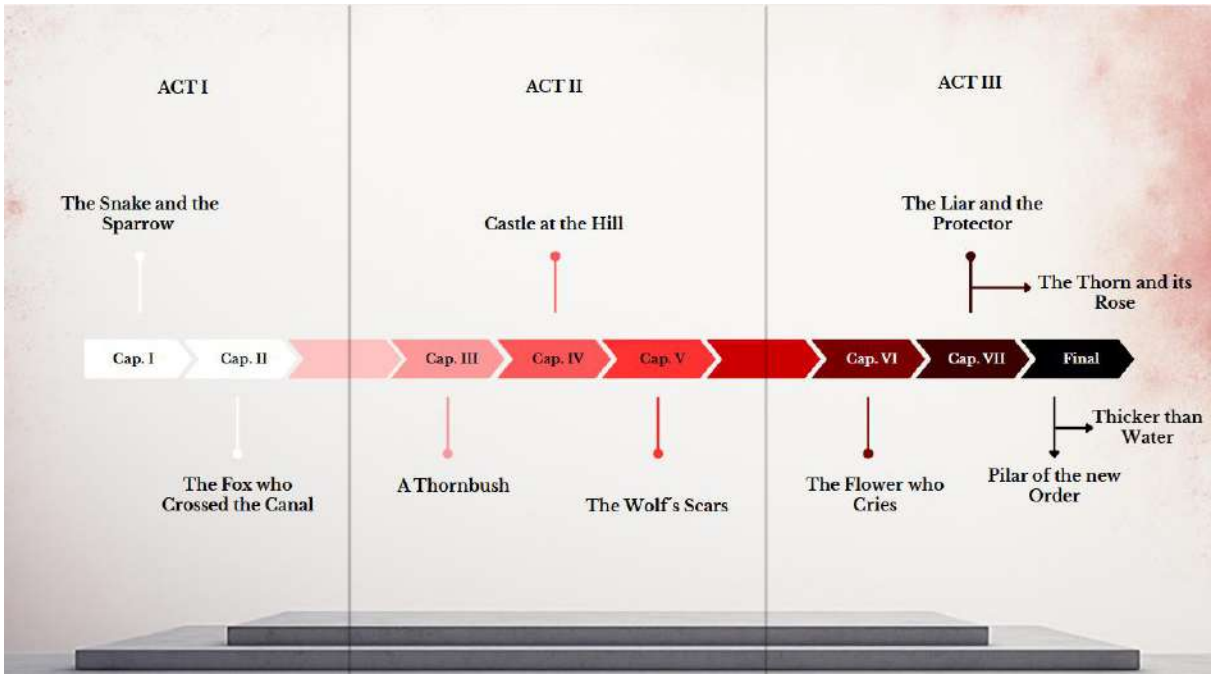
Endings

- **Pilar of the New Order:** Silvia accepts that the world must change. She allies with the Pope and inherits Volpe's vision. She confronts Imperia to avenge her friend. A new order is born, and Silvia stands at its head as the leader of a new Conclave.

- **Thicker Than Water:** Silvia rejects the Pope and the corrupt Church. She resolves to purge the Holy See from within. The final confrontation is against the Swiss Guard. The world remains as it was.

If, during Chapter VI, the player completes the side mission tied to María's favor, they are given the option to intervene and protect Volpe during her execution. Should they do so, Chapter VI branches into a new direction and unlocks an additional ending:

- **The Thorn and its Rose:** Silvia and Volpe flee the Conclave with Giacomo's help, having decided they will not die for the quarrels of others. They confront Imperia. In the duel, Volpe sacrifices herself for Silvia; but upon seeing the two women who were like daughters to her, willing to die to protect one another, Imperia lets them live. In this ending, the system does not fall, nor does Silvia seize power, but it is the only ending in which Silvia and Volpe cease to be weapons and are, at last, free.



Level Outline

Chapter I: The Snake and the Sparrow

The level takes place in an exterior district of Venice on the night of the masquerade festival. Its progression is linear, functioning as a tutorial that allows the player to experiment with parkour mechanics, interrogation techniques, and basic combat.

Level Breakdown

1. **Opening and Movement Tutorial**: Silvia begins near St. Mark's Square. The player must ascend to the rooftops, learning the movement mechanics in order to avoid ground patrols.

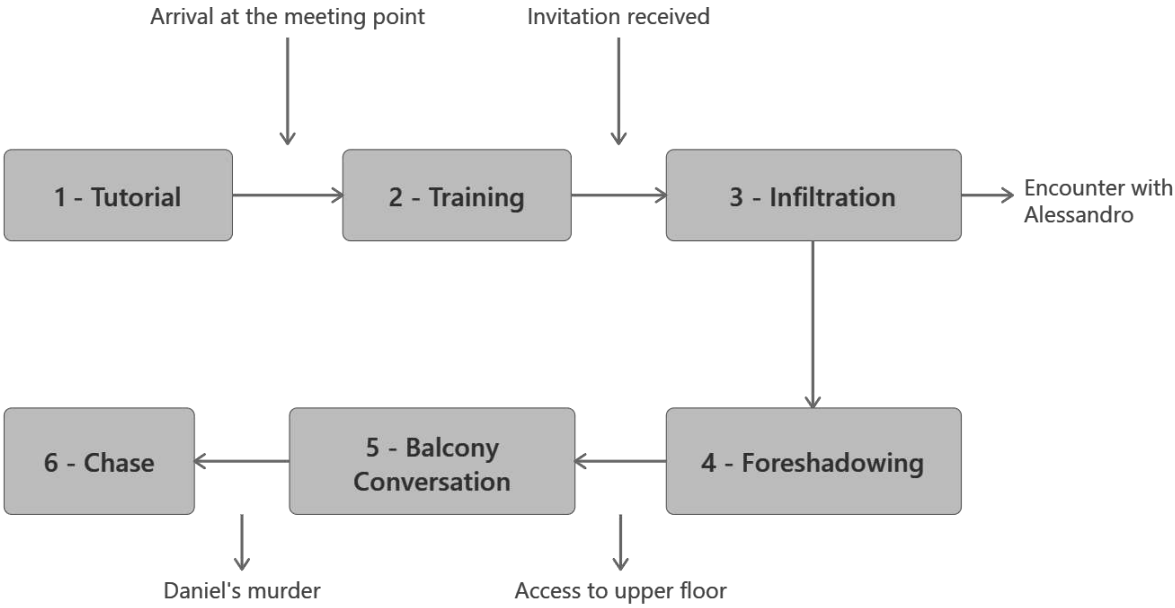
2. **Meeting with Giacomo Casanova**: Upon reaching the rendezvous point, a low-stakes practice fight against Casanova is triggered. The player must perform several maneuvers, including parries and dodges, to familiarize themselves with the combat system, after which they receive the forged invitation.
3. **Infiltration of the Palazzo Rainer**: Silvia enters the palazzo. The player must activate the Disguise mechanic (noble attire) to blend in at the party. The objective is to conduct reconnaissance: eavesdrop on conversations, engage

guests using the Seduction/Diplomacy/Aggression dialogue system, and ultimately locate Daniel Reiner.

4. **Encounter with Cagliostro**: The player comes across Alessandro Cagliostro addressing a small crowd of nobles, offering virgin lands in the New World at a suspiciously low price; a piece of foreshadowing for his future role as the game's chief trickster.

5. **Murder at the Balcony**: After isolating Daniel Reiner in a private area, the cutscene described in the "Cutscene Script" section is triggered. The narrative takes center stage here, presenting the chapter's core conflict: Daniel's murder at the hands of a third party.

6. **Flight and Double Chase**: The mission concludes with an intense pursuit sequence that tests everything the player has learned, descending toward the docks while both characters evade the Venetian Guard, who are attempting to arrest them both.



Cutscene Script

EXT. PALAZZO RAINER. BALCONY. NIGHT

The music of the masquerade ball drifts through the air, muffled and distant.

DANIEL REINER, a visibly nervous nobleman, wipes the sweat from his brow. SILVIA slips out of the shadows, her closed fan tapping a slow rhythm against her palm.

SILVIA
Your brother Paul is an ambitious man, Daniel. But the Vatican values obedience over talent.

DANIEL
(Startled)
Who...? Ah. Valenti's protégé. Paul is no threat. He simply... has new ideas.

Silvia snaps her fan open with a sharp flick. The metal of the "Rose Thorns" catches the moonlight.

SILVIA
In Rome, "new ideas" tend to end at the bonfire, or in the Tiber. Choose your allegiances wisely.

Silvia steps closer, closing the fan and using it to lift Daniel's chin.

SILVIA (CONT'D)
Be the Doge the Church needs, and your sins shall be... forgiven.

A sharp whistle cuts through the air. Daniel crumples. A crystal dart protrudes from his throat.

SILVIA (CONT'D)

No!

Silvia's eyes snap toward the dart's origin. A MASKED FIGURE pockets a blowpipe and leaps into the void. Without hesitation, Silvia sprints to the railing and jumps after them.

CUT TO:

GAMEPLAY. CHASE SEQUENCE